RAISING MUSLIM CHILDREN

in

INTERFAITH FAMILIES



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The Challenge Facing Our Families

Parents, learners and educators today face **unprecedented** psychological, emotional and personal pressures.

THESE PRESSURES DIRECTLY AFFECT

- Learning
- Relationships
- Behaviour
- Wellbeing

Academic success is difficult without **spiritual, emotional and psychological wellbeing.**

PARENTING

A Responsibility, Not Just an Opinion

Parenting is the easiest thing to have an opinion about and one of the **hardest things to actually do.** It requires:

Patience | Sacrifice | Wisdom | Consistency | Presence

More than providing

Food, clothing and education are only the beginning. Every child is different, so we must understand, guide, listen and nurture through each stage of life.

It is about

- Building **character**
- Instilling **values**
- Preparing a child **for life**

PARENTING

Parenting Cannot Be Delegated

A school can educate

A teacher can guide

A community can support

> …but no one can replace the role of a parent.

Children need our **presence, attention, love and guidance**, in their emotional, spiritual, social and personal development.

Parenting is a responsibility entrusted to us, not one that can be outsourced.

THE PROPHETIC MODEL ﷺ

Every Child is a Mercy – Mercy for Mercy

The Prophet ﷺ with children

- He **kissed** them
- He **carried** them
- He **spoke gently** to them

When a man said he had never kissed his children, the Prophet ﷺ replied:

"What can I do for you if Allah has removed mercy from your heart?"

Mercy is not weakness. It is Sunnah.

THE PROPHETIC MODEL ﷺ

Nurturing with Wisdom

Taleem & Tarbiyah

- Mercy goes hand in hand with teaching and discipline
- He ﷺ taught children prayer early and nurtured faith gradually
- With wisdom and patience, **never with humiliation or cruelty**

Dignity & Respect

- Anas ibn Mālik R served the Prophet ﷺ for ten years and was never rebuked harshly
- Constant criticism and anger **destroy hearts**
- Gentleness **builds them**

Teach by Example

- Children learn Islam from what we **do**, not only what we say
- Our salah, honesty, character and treatment of others
- A righteous example is the **strongest form of Tarbiyah**

INTERFAITH FAMILIES

Guidance from the Qur'an and Sunnah

"No child is born but that he is upon the **fitra** (natural instinct). His parents make him a Jew, or a Christian, or a Magian."

Bukhari and Muslim

"And We have enjoined upon man **goodness to parents**. But if they endeavour to make you associate with Me that of which you have no knowledge, do not obey them."

Surah Al-'Ankabut 29:8

When Asmā''s mother, not yet Muslim, came seeking her help, the Prophet ﷺ said: "Yes. **Keep a good relationship with your mother.**"

Bukhari and Muslim

"Indeed, you do not guide whom you like, but **Allah guides whom He wills.** And He is most knowing of the rightly guided."

Surah Al-Qasas 28:56

INTERFAITH FAMILIES

Raising Children Between Two Traditions

Exposure to two faiths need not confuse a child. With wisdom and love, a firm Islamic foundation builds on shared values: **belief in Almighty, kindness and justice.**

A Harmonious Home

- **Consistent values:** teaching Islam never means criticising the other parent
- **Positive exposure:** stories, the Seerah, faith and character
- **Open conversations:** answer questions with patience

A Strong Identity

- **Community:** masjid visits, Islamic classes, youth programmes
- **Befriend your child:** firm but loving guidance
- **Social influences:** dialogue, not harsh criticism

Growing Together

- **Gradually:** teach Islam through everyday life
- **Joyfully:** stories, videos and community activities
- **Closely:** quality time, listening, gentle guidance

TAKE-AWAYS

Children Don’t Listen. They Watch.

We tell them to pray…	They notice when we pray, how we pray, and when we don’t.
We tell them not to lie…	They hear how we bend the truth.
In a crisis…	They see whether we panic or pray, react or respond.
When we are angry…	Let them see mercy in how we speak, apologise and forgive.

> Your home is their first **Madrasah**.

> Your behaviour is their first **Tafseer**.

Children absorb habits, not lectures. Advice only works when our character speaks first.

IN SHORT

The Work Is Not on Them. It Is on Us

Prepare yourself, not through perfect parenting, but through **honest living.**

Become the Muslim you hope they will grow into.

One day they will not repeat your words. They will repeat **you**.

DUA FOR PARENTING

رَبَّنَا هَبْ لَنَا مِنْ أَزْوَاجِنَا وَذُرِّيَّاتِنَا قُرَّةَ أَعْيُنٍ وَاجْعَلْنَا لِلْمُتَّقِينَ إِمَامًا

Rabbana hab lana min azwajina wa dhurriyyatina qurrata a'yunin waj'alna lil-muttaqina imama.

"Our Lord, grant us from our spouses and offspring comfort to our eyes, and make us leaders of the righteous."

Surah Al-Furqan 25:74